



THE HOUSING INFO STYLE GUIDES

The Modern Vintage Style Guide

The details that make the look, and how to recreate it.

WELCOME

A home that feels collected, not like a museum

Rich wood tones, classic details and pieces that feel gathered over time. Modern Vintage at its best feels elegant, nostalgic and beautifully lived-in. Layered with history and warmth, but still fresh enough for everyday living.

It looks effortless, but it is not random. Every room follows the same few rules: a warm linen-white backdrop, dark wood used with confidence, classic architecture, brass light and soft cream upholstery. This guide breaks those rules down into paint colors, materials and simple formulas you can follow room by room.

Use it in order the first time, then come back to the checklists whenever you are ready to tackle the next space.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Start with the palette and wood tone, since they tie every room together. Then add architecture and lighting, and finish with furniture, rugs and styling. Always sample paint on your own walls before committing.

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THE LOOK

The Modern Vintage formula

Six ingredients show up in every room. Get these right and the rest falls into place.

01

A warm linen-white backdrop

Soft, creamy whites on walls and trim let dark wood and brass glow. Never stark, blue or grey white.

02

Dark wood, used with confidence

Dark walnut on cabinetry, case pieces, doors and herringbone floors. It is what makes these rooms feel rich and grounded.

03

Classic architecture

Wall moulding, arched doorways, glass-front cabinets and black steel-framed doors give even a new home a sense of history.

04

Brass light everywhere

Candle chandeliers, pleated-shade lamps, glass globe pendants and picture lights, all glowing warm and low.

05

Cream upholstery & cognac leather

Soft cream sofas and chairs keep all that wood light; cognac leather adds patina and warmth.

06

Florals, art & living things

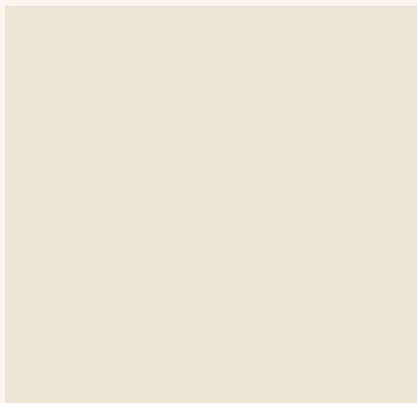
Floral vintage rugs, framed oil paintings, porcelain, fresh flowers and potted trees make it feel gathered over time.



INSIDE THE GUIDE

The color palette

Six colors and finishes do all the work: a warm linen white, soft cream, dark walnut, dusty blue, blush pink and antique brass.

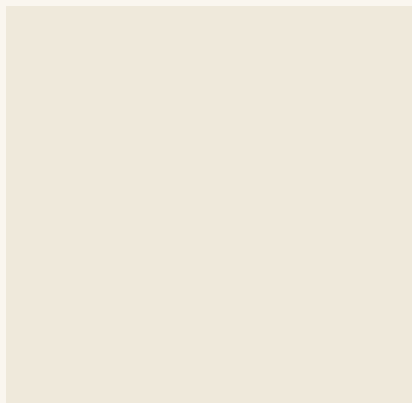


WALLS

Linen White

Benjamin Moore 912

A soft, creamy white for walls and ceilings in every room.

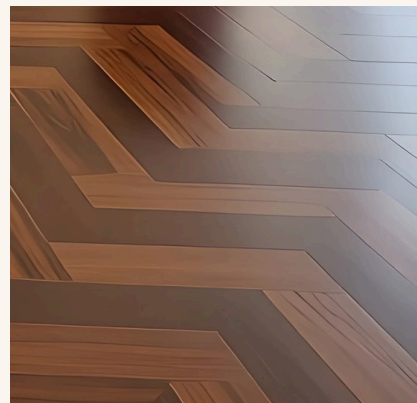


TRIM & UPHOLSTERY

Pointing

Farrow & Ball No. 2003

A warm cream for trim, painted cabinetry and to match upholstery to.



WOOD

Dark Walnut

Minwax stain 2716

The dominant wood for cabinetry, case pieces, doors and floors.



ACCENT

Oval Room Blue

Farrow & Ball No. 85

A dusty, grey-blue for a bedroom, bedding, a pantry or porcelain.



ACCENT

Setting Plaster

Farrow & Ball No. 231

A soft blush for a powder room, a reading nook or floral textiles.



METAL

Antique Brass

Aged brass finish

For chandeliers, sconces, hardware and frames. Warm and softly gleaming.

Colors shown are printed or on-screen previews and will vary by device. Always test real samples on your walls in morning and evening light before you paint.

THE PALETTE

Where each color goes

Modern Vintage works because every color sits on the same warm undertone as the dark wood. Let the linen white and cream do most of the work and use blue and blush in small, repeated doses.

SURFACE	COLOR	SHEEN	NOTES
Walls	Linen White, BM 912	Matte or eggshell	Use eggshell in kitchens and baths for wipeability.
Trim & moulding	Pointing, F&B 2003	Satin	A shade creamier than the walls so moulding reads softly.
Ceilings	Linen White, BM 912	Flat	A warm ceiling keeps chandelier light glowing, not grey.
Painted cabinetry	Pointing, F&B 2003	Satin	A kitchen island, lower cabinets or a vanity in cream.
Bedroom or nook	Oval Room Blue, F&B 85	Matte	One room, the back of a glass cabinet or a pantry.
Powder room	Setting Plaster, F&B 231	Matte	A small room, a ceiling or the inside of a cabinet.
Wood stain	Dark Walnut, Minwax 2716	Oil or satin	Match new shelves, doors and furniture to your floors.

ALSO TRY, WARM WHITES

Benjamin Moore White Dove OC-17 · Benjamin Moore Swiss Coffee OC-45 · Sherwin-Williams Alabaster SW 7008 · Farrow & Ball Wimborne White No. 239

ALSO TRY, BLUES & BLUSH

Farrow & Ball Lulworth Blue No. 89 · Benjamin Moore Wythe Blue HC-143 · Farrow & Ball Pink Ground No. 202 · Farrow & Ball Calamine No. 230

DESIGNER TIP

Pair dark walnut with a creamy white, not a bright white. Bright white makes dark wood look harsh; a warm white makes it look rich. Test large samples next to your wood at 9am and 7pm.

MATERIALS

Wood, fabric & texture

Dark wood, soft cream fabrics and a little gleam are exactly what keep these rooms elegant instead of heavy.



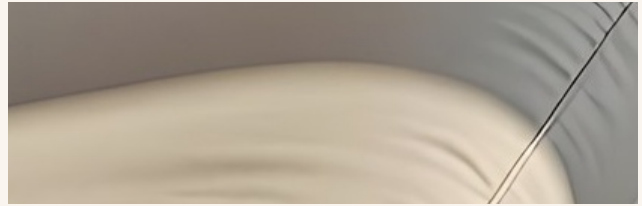
Wood: dark walnut & herringbone

- ◆ Dark walnut on cabinetry, case pieces, doors and stair rails.
- ◆ Herringbone or chevron wood floors in a warm mid-to-dark tone.
- ◆ Keep one dominant dark wood; repeat it in at least three places per room.



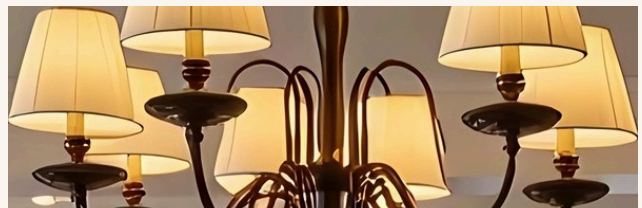
Rugs: floral & vintage-inspired

- ◆ Cream floral rugs with soft blue, pink and rust in living rooms and bedrooms.
- ◆ Vintage-style runners in halls and kitchens.
- ◆ One patterned rug per room is plenty; keep upholstery solid around it.



Fabric: cream, linen & leather

- ◆ Cream or ivory upholstery on sofas, armchairs and dining chairs.
- ◆ Cognac leather on an armchair or club chair; it only gets better with age.
- ◆ Linen, cotton and velvet pillows in cream, dusty blue and soft blush.



Light: brass, glass & pleats

- ◆ Antique brass candle chandeliers with small cream shades.
- ◆ Clear glass globe pendants over islands and tables.
- ◆ Pleated fabric lamp shades and brass picture lights for a soft evening glow.

WOOD & ARCHITECTURE GUIDE

Adding character to a plain room

Moulding, glass-front cabinets, herringbone floors and dark wood are what make these rooms feel classic. Here is how to add them, even to a builder-grade home. Costs below are rough ranges and vary by region and home.

01

Glass-front display cabinets

Dark wood cabinets with glass doors, full of porcelain, books and ceramics, give a room instant character and a sense of history.

DIY (IKEA glass-door cabinets + dark stain): \$400 to \$1,500 · **Pro built-in:** \$5,000 to \$15,000

Add a warm LED strip inside so the shelves glow at night.

02

Wall moulding

Picture-frame or panel moulding painted in your cream trim color adds the classic detail these rooms are known for.

DIY: \$150 to \$500 per wall · **Pro:** \$800 to \$2,500 per wall

Paint moulding and wall the same color for a subtle look.

03

Herringbone floors

Herringbone wood floors are the signature of the look and make even a plain room feel old-world and tailored.

Herringbone LVP, DIY: \$4 to \$8 per sq ft · **Engineered wood, pro:** \$15 to \$30 per sq ft

Renting? A large vintage rug does a lot of the same work.

04

Dark wood cabinetry & doors

Restaining or replacing cabinets and interior doors in dark walnut ties the whole home together.

DIY gel stain: \$150 to \$400 · **Pro refinish:** \$3,000 to \$8,000 for a kitchen

Pair with aged brass hardware so dark wood never feels flat.

WHERE TO START

If you only do one thing, add a dark wood glass-front cabinet to your living or dining room and fill it with porcelain and books. It is the single biggest change for the money.

WOOD & ARCHITECTURE GUIDE

Details that finish the shell

Once the big moves are done, these smaller upgrades carry the look into every corner.

- ◆ **Arched doorways.** An arch between rooms, or an arched mirror where you cannot add one, softens all the straight lines.
- ◆ **Black steel-framed glass doors.** Slim steel-and-glass doors or partitions let light through and feel both old and modern.
- ◆ **Panel doors and brass hardware.** Dark wood panel doors with aged brass knobs, bin pulls and cup pulls.
- ◆ **Ceiling medallions and coves.** A plaster medallion above the chandelier and warm cove lighting add old-world polish.
- ◆ **Framed oil paintings.** Landscapes and florals in gilded or wood frames, lit with brass picture lights.
- ◆ **Porcelain, flowers and trees.** Blue-and-white porcelain, fresh roses and potted trees keep it alive and lived-in.

DESIGNER TIP

Keep walls and trim in warm white and cream throughout the home and let dark wood carry the contrast. Save blue and blush for textiles, porcelain and one or two rooms.



LIGHTING FORMULA

Brass, glass and a warm glow

Brass chandeliers, pleated-shade lamps, glass globe pendants and picture lights do the heavy lifting. Use at least three light sources at different heights in every room for that warm evening glow.

2700K

BULB COLOR TEMPERATURE

90+

CRI FOR TRUE COLORS

3+

LIGHT SOURCES PER ROOM

FIXTURE	HOW BIG	HOW HIGH
Living chandelier	Room length + width in feet = diameter in inches	At least 7 ft clear of the floor
Dining chandelier	About half to two-thirds of the table's width	30 to 34 inches above the tabletop
Globe pendants	10 to 14 inches each; 2 or 3 over an island	30 to 36 inches above the counter
Wall sconces	Scaled to the mirror, art or stair they light	60 to 66 inches from the floor to center
Reading lamps	Pleated shade, one beside every reading chair	Bottom of shade about 40 inches high
Picture lights	About half to two-thirds of the frame's width	Mounted just above the frame

CHOOSE

Antique brass candle chandeliers with small shades, clear glass globes, pleated fabric lamp shades and brass picture lights.

PUT EVERYTHING ON DIMMERS

Dimmed, warm light at night is what makes dark wood glow. Add warm LED strips inside glass cabinets and in ceiling coves.

FURNITURE & FABRICS

Cream, leather and dark wood

The mix is what keeps it fresh: soft cream upholstery, rich leather, dark wood and a few gentle color moments.

60% LINEN WHITE & CREAM

30% DARK
WALNUT

10% ACCENTS

- ◆ **Sofas:** cream or ivory with a classic shape, like a rolled or English arm, deep and comfortable.
- ◆ **Accent chairs:** cognac leather armchairs or a cream reading chair with a wood frame.
- ◆ **Wood:** dark walnut case pieces, round pedestal tables and turned or tapered legs. One wood tone, repeated.
- ◆ **Mix eras:** pair antique or vintage pieces with clean-lined new ones, never a matching set.
- ◆ **Fabrics:** solid cream, linen and leather on the big pieces. Pattern comes from rugs, pillows and art.
- ◆ **Scale:** leave 18 inches between a sofa and coffee table, and 30 to 36 inches for walkways.

VINTAGE, NOT OLD-FASHIONED

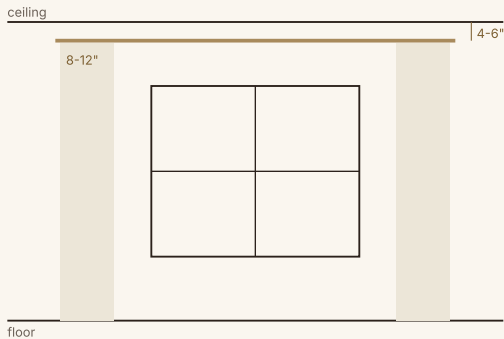
Too many antiques and it feels like a museum. Balance every dark, heavy piece with something light: cream upholstery, glass, a plant or a pale rug.

RUGS, WINDOWS & DRAPERY

Soft, light and grounded

These rooms feel airy because light pours through tall windows and soft linen, and every zone is anchored by a rug. These simple numbers make ceilings look taller and rooms feel finished.

Window & drapery rules



- ◆ Mount the rod 4 to 6 inches below the ceiling, or halfway between the window top and ceiling.
- ◆ Extend the rod 8 to 12 inches past the frame on each side.
- ◆ Fabric width 2 to 2.5 times the window width; let panels kiss the floor.
- ◆ Sheer or lined linen in ivory or oatmeal on a slim antique brass rod.
- ◆ On tall black steel windows, keep drapery light so the frames stay the feature.

Rug rules

ROOM	RULE OF THUMB
Living	A cream floral rug; front legs of every seat on it.
Dining	24 to 30 inches beyond the table on all sides; round rug under a round table.
Bedroom	18 to 24 inches showing on each side of the bed.
Entry & hall	A vintage-style runner with 4 to 6 inches of floor on each side.
Kitchen	A washable vintage-style runner in front of the sink.

LOOK FOR

Cream floral rugs with soft blue, pink and rust, in a hand-knotted or vintage-washed look. Go bigger than feels natural.



ROOM 01 · THE ENTRY

A graceful welcome

A curving staircase with a wrought-iron railing, herringbone wood floors, a dark wood console and framed landscapes lit by brass sconces. It sets a classic, collected tone from the moment you walk in.

THE FORMULA

01 Start with a dark wood console

A dark walnut chest or console with brass hardware gives you a landing spot and sets the wood tone for the home.

02 Hang a stair gallery

Frame landscapes and florals in gold or wood and hang them at a consistent height, following the angle of the handrail.

03 Light it with brass

Brass sconces along the stair or beside a mirror, plus a lamp on the console, so the entry glows at night.

04 Add something living

Fresh flowers in porcelain and a potted tree soften all the wood and iron.

DESIGNER TIP

Hang a small gallery of framed art along the stairs at a consistent height, following the angle of the handrail.

SKIP THIS

A bare wall and a single ceiling light. Add art, a lamp and a mirror so the first impression feels warm.

CHECKLIST

☐ Walls Linen White☐ Dark wood console☐ Framed stair gallery☐ Brass sconces☐ Arched brass mirror☐ Vintage-style runner

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Baylor sconce · Sansome arch mirror · Honora runner · hand painted ginger jar · faux olive tree



ROOM 02 · THE LIVING ROOM

A place to gather

Soft cream sofas, cognac leather armchairs, a round dark wood coffee table and a floral vintage rug, framed by glass-front display cabinets full of porcelain and books.

THE FORMULA

01 Anchor with a floral rug

Choose a rug large enough that the front legs of every seat rest on it. It pulls the whole seating area together.

02 Cream sofa, leather chairs

A cream sofa with a pair of cognac leather armchairs gives softness and patina in one move.

03 Hang a brass chandelier

A candle-style chandelier sized to the room, plus lamps with pleated shades at seated eye level.

04 Display what you collect

Glass-front cabinets filled with porcelain, books and ceramics make the room feel gathered over time.

DESIGNER TIP

Choose a rug large enough that the front legs of every seat rest on it. It pulls the whole seating area together.

SKIP THIS

A matched sofa and loveseat set. Mix cream upholstery with leather and wood so it looks collected.

CHECKLIST

☐ Cream sofa☐ Cognac leather armchairs☐ Round dark wood coffee table☐ Floral vintage rug☐ Brass chandelier☐ Glass-front display cabinet

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Lucille sofa · Mihaela coffee table · Camille chandelier · Rosa rug · Soren table lamp

ROOM 03 · THE DINING ROOM

Made for long dinners

A round wood dining table with upholstered chairs, an arched doorway, a pleated-shade floor lamp and fresh flowers. Sunlight and dark wood keep it warm and inviting.

THE FORMULA

01 Go round and dark

A round dark wood pedestal table seats more people in less space and keeps conversation easy.

02 Upholster the chairs

Cream upholstered chairs soften all the wood and make long dinners comfortable.

03 Light it two ways

A brass chandelier 30 to 34 inches above the table, plus a pleated floor lamp or sconce in a corner.

04 Set out flowers and porcelain

A low vase of roses and a glass cabinet of china make the room feel used and loved.

DESIGNER TIP

A round table seats more people in less space and keeps conversation easy. Leave about 36 inches around it to walk.

SKIP THIS

A tiny chandelier over a big table. Go bigger than you think so the light reads as a feature.

CHECKLIST

☐ Round dark wood table

☐ Cream upholstered chairs

☐ Brass chandelier

☐ Glass-front china cabinet

☐ Round or floral rug

☐ Fresh flowers in porcelain

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Palisades table · Lowe dining chair · Georgiana chandelier · Morris cabinet · Dutch Flowers print

ROOM 04 · THE KITCHEN

A classic kitchen

A cream island with a dark stone top, dark wood bar stools, glass globe pendants and open shelving styled with ceramics and plants. Warm, elegant and easy to live in.

THE FORMULA

01 Cream with dark accents

Pair cream cabinetry with a dark stone top, dark wood stools and shelving for a tailored contrast.

02 Hang glass globes

Two or three clear glass globe pendants over the island keep the room light and airy.

03 Style open shelves

Dark wood shelves or a glass cabinet with ceramics, cookbooks and a trailing plant.

04 Warm up the details

Aged brass bin pulls, a vintage-style runner and a bowl of fruit keep it from feeling sterile.

DESIGNER TIP

Pair cream cabinetry with dark wood stools and shelving. The contrast makes a simple kitchen feel tailored and vintage.

SKIP THIS

Stark white everything and chrome. Choose cream, dark wood and brass so the room glows instead of glares.

CHECKLIST

☐ Cream island and cabinets

☐ Dark stone countertop

☐ Dark wood counter stools

☐ Glass globe pendants

☐ Brass bin pulls

☐ Open shelves with ceramics

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Anderson globe pendant · Amapa counter stool · Massey bin pull · Honora runner · ginger jar



ROOM 05 · THE READING CORNER

A quiet reading corner

Black steel-framed glass doors, a cream armchair, dark wood cabinets and a brass chandelier, with oil paintings and a lamp for evening reading.

THE FORMULA

01 Choose one great chair

A cream or cognac leather armchair with arms and a high back you can actually sink into.

02 Give it its own lamp

A pleated-shade floor or table lamp with the bottom of the shade about 40 inches from the floor.

03 Add a surface

A small dark wood side table or cabinet for tea, books and a vase of flowers.

04 Frame it with art

An oil painting or two above the chair, lit with a brass picture light.

DESIGNER TIP

Give every reading chair its own lamp, about 40 inches from the floor to the bottom of the shade.

SKIP THIS

A chair floating in a corner with no light. A lamp, a table and art are what make it a destination.

CHECKLIST

☐ Cream or leather armchair☐ Pleated-shade floor lamp☐ Dark wood side table☐ Oil painting and picture light☐ Steel-framed glass doors☐ Throw and a small rug

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Rudy armchair · Callahan floor lamp · Roman picture light · Baylor sconce · Knit throw



ROOM 06 · THE BEDROOM

A restful bedroom

A dark wood bed with cream and dusty blue bedding, a floral rug in soft blues and pinks, glass-front wardrobes, a brass chandelier and botanical art above the headboard.

THE FORMULA

01 Dark bed, light bedding

Keep bedding light, cream and one soft accent color, so the dark wood furniture feels rich, not heavy.

02 Layer in dusty blue

A blue pillow or coverlet, a floral rug with blue and pink, and blue in the art tie it together.

03 Add a chandelier

A small brass chandelier and swing-arm sconces or lamps on each side of the bed.

04 Hang botanicals

A framed floral or botanical painting centered above the headboard.

DESIGNER TIP

Keep bedding light (cream and one soft accent color) so the dark wood furniture feels rich, not heavy.

SKIP THIS

Dark bedding with dark furniture. The room will feel heavy; let the bed linens be the light.

CHECKLIST

☐ Dark wood bed☐ Cream and dusty blue bedding☐ Dark wood nightstands☐ Floral rug in blue and pink☐ Small brass chandelier☐ Botanical art above the bed

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 19

Shaw bed · Tate nightstand · Eden swing-arm sconce · Emery linen curtain · Knit throw

CURATED SHOPPING

Where to shop the look

Mix a few investment pieces with vintage finds and affordable basics. These are the go-to sources for each category, from splurge to save.

CATEGORY	SPLURGE	MID-RANGE	SAVE & VINTAGE
Lighting	Visual Comfort, Urban Electric	Rejuvenation, Pottery Barn, McGee & Co.	Target, Amazon, vintage on Chairish
Rugs	Lulu and Georgia, Jaipur Living	Loloi, Rifle Paper Co., Pottery Barn	Ruggable, vintage rugs on Etsy
Upholstery	McGee & Co., Arhaus	Crate & Barrel, Pottery Barn	Target, Burrow, Marketplace
Dark wood & vintage	1stDibs, Arhaus	Crate & Barrel, Rejuvenation	Chairish, AptDeco, estate sales
Art & frames	Tappan, Saatchi Art	Juniper Print Shop, Framebridge	Etsy oil paintings, thrifted frames
Hardware	Waterworks, Nanz	Rejuvenation, Schoolhouse	Amerock, solid brass on Etsy
Drapery	The Shade Store, Loom Decor	Pottery Barn, West Elm	IKEA, Target, H&M Home linen
Paint	Farrow & Ball	Benjamin Moore, Sherwin-Williams	Color-matched samples at your local store

SEARCH TERMS THAT WORK

"antique brass candle chandelier" · "pleated lamp shade" · "glass globe pendant" · "vintage floral rug" · "walnut glass front cabinet" · "vintage oil painting" · "blue and white ginger jar"

VINTAGE SHOPPING TIP

Buy dark wood case pieces and art vintage, and upholstery new. Solid wood dressers and cabinets last forever; old foam and fabric rarely do.

THE SHOPPING LIST

Shop the rooms

Every piece below was chosen to recreate the rooms in this guide, from trusted sources like Rejuvenation, Pottery Barn, McGee & Co., Crate & Barrel and Visual Comfort.

LIGHTING

Camille Small Candle Chandelier Visual Comfort	Living room	\$1,599	SHOP visualcomfort.com
Anderson Clear Glass Globe Pendant Pottery Barn	Kitchen	\$270–\$549	SHOP potterybarn.com
Soren Table Lamp, Pleated Shade Visual Comfort	Living room	\$599	SHOP visualcomfort.com
Callahan Pleated-Shade Floor Lamp Rejuvenation	Reading corner	\$599	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Roman Brass Picture Light Rejuvenation	Living room	\$399–\$549	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Baylor Pleated Shade Sconce Pottery Barn	Entry & reading corner	\$99	SHOP potterybarn.com
Georgiana Pleated Chandelier McGee & Co.	Dining room	\$2,749	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Eden Swing-Arm Sconce Rejuvenation	Bedroom	\$329	SHOP rejuvenation.com

FURNITURE

Lucille English Roll Arm Sofa McGee & Co.	Living room	\$4,989	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Rudy Rolled Arm Chair, Cognac Arhaus	Reading corner	\$2,500	SHOP arhaus.com
Mihaela Round Coffee Table, Walnut Arhaus	Living room	\$2,730–\$3,010	SHOP arhaus.com
Palisades Walnut Pedestal Table Crate & Barrel	Dining room	\$1,299	SHOP crateandbarrel.com
Lowe Ivory Upholstered Dining Chair Crate & Barrel	Dining room	\$299	SHOP crateandbarrel.com

THE SHOPPING LIST · CONTINUED

Shop the rooms

Furniture, rugs, curtains, art and the finishing hardware that pull every room together.

FURNITURE

Amapa Walnut Counter Stool Crate & Barrel	Kitchen	\$699	SHOP crateandbarrel.com
Shaw Walnut Bed Rejuvenation	Bedroom	\$1,851–\$3,699	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Tate Walnut Nightstand Crate & Barrel	Bedroom	\$599	SHOP crateandbarrel.com
Morris Wood & Glass Bookcase Cabinet Crate & Barrel	Dining room	\$1,399	SHOP crateandbarrel.com

RUGS & TEXTILES

Rosa Antique Rose Rug, Sky Rifle Paper Co.	Living room	From \$71	SHOP riflepaperco.com
Honora Vintage-Style Runner Lulu and Georgia	Entry	\$38–\$1,142	SHOP luluandgeorgia.com
Emery Linen Curtain, Ivory Pottery Barn	Every room	\$199–\$479	SHOP potterybarn.com
Knit Throw Blanket, Cream Target (Threshold x Studio McGee)	Bedroom	\$40	SHOP target.com

DECOR & HARDWARE

Hand Painted Ginger Jar McGee & Co.	Living room	\$278	SHOP mcgeeandco.com
Dutch Flowers Still Life Print Juniper Print Shop	Dining room	\$20–\$299	SHOP juniperprintshop.com
Massey Brass Bin Pull Rejuvenation	Kitchen	\$17–\$21	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Sansome Arch Mirror, Antique Brass Pottery Barn	Entry	\$299	SHOP potterybarn.com
Faux Olive Tree in Ceramic Pot Target (Threshold x Studio McGee)	Every room	\$180	SHOP target.com

Prices and availability were checked in October 2026 and may change. Every item is a designer pick chosen to complete the look. Tap any item name or Shop to open it.

WHY YOU CAN'T JUST COPY A PHOTO

Mistakes to avoid

Saving inspiration is easy. Getting it to look right in your own home is the hard part. These are the most common places it goes wrong.

01

Trusting screen colors

A warm white on your phone can turn grey, yellow or pink on your walls. Use real paint codes and sample them.

02

Too much dark wood

Dark walls, dark floors and dark furniture together feel heavy. Balance dark wood with cream walls, light and pattern.

03

Skipping the architecture

Moulding, glass-front cabinets and herringbone are what make it feel classic. Add at least one to a plain room.

04

Going full museum

Too many antiques feels stuffy. Keep it fresh with light, plants and a few clean-lined pieces.

05

Bright white everything

Stark white walls make dark wood look harsh. Use a warm linen white and cream instead.

06

Cool or mixed metals

Chrome and brushed nickel fight the warmth. Stick with antique brass and a little black iron.

07

Getting scale wrong

Small rugs, short curtains and tiny chandeliers make a room feel unfinished. Follow the numbers in this guide.

08

Relying on overheads

A single ceiling light flattens everything. Add lamps, sconces and picture lights on dimmers.

KEEP THIS HANDY

The cheat sheet

Every number in one place. Screenshot it, print it or save it to your phone before you shop.

COLOR & FINISH

Walls & ceilings	Linen White BM 912
Trim & cabinetry	Pointing F&B 2003
Accent	Oval Room Blue F&B 85
Accent	Setting Plaster F&B 231
Wood stain	Dark Walnut Minwax 2716
Metal	Antique brass

LIGHTING

Bulbs	2700K, CRI 90+, dimmable
Dining chandelier	30 to 34" above table
Island pendants	30 to 36" above counter
Sconces	60 to 66" to center
Reading lamp	Shade bottom about 40"

WINDOWS & RUGS

Curtain rod	4 to 6" below ceiling
Rod overhang	8 to 12" each side
Panel fullness	2 to 2.5x window width
Living rug	Front legs of every seat on it
Dining rug	24 to 30" past the table
Bedroom rug	18 to 24" each side

ART & LAYOUT

Art over furniture	About 2/3 its width
Stair gallery	Follow the handrail angle
Around a dining table	About 36" to walk
Sofa to coffee table	18"
Accent colors	Repeat each 3 times



THANK YOU

Bring the look home

Start with the palette and one dark wood tone, add classic details and warm brass light, and collect slowly. Your home does not need to be finished in a weekend to feel beautiful.

Want a designer's eye on your own rooms? Housing Info offers virtual design packages with a custom plan, shopping links and visual mockups. Send us a message on Instagram to get started.

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